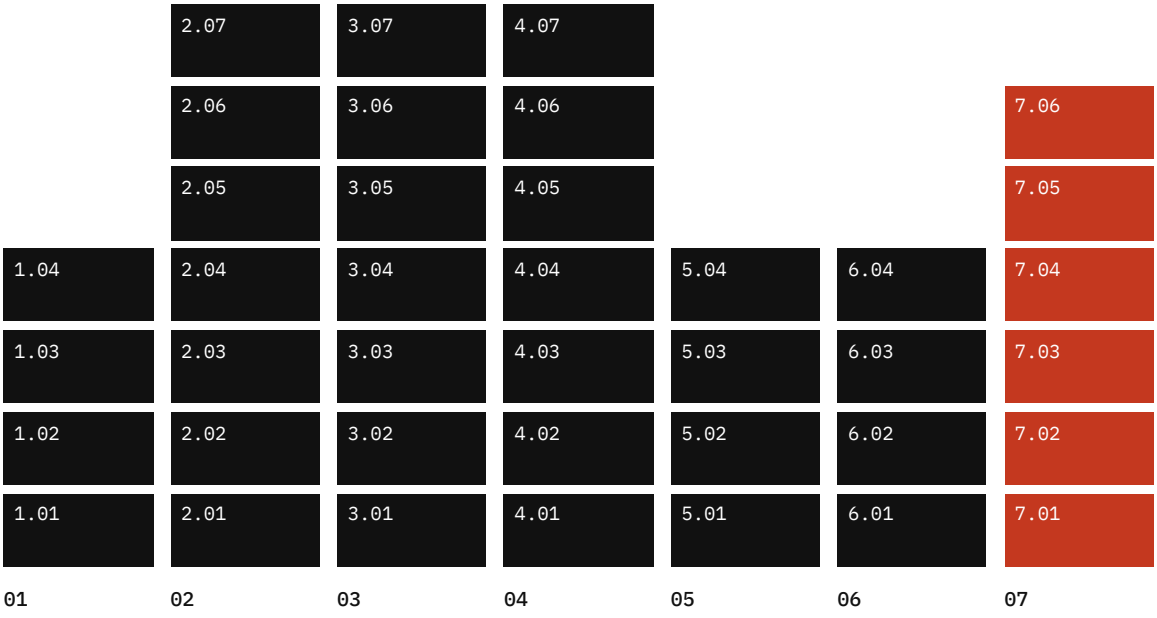
Framework Thinking.

The Professional's Thinking Partner

How to think through a problem in front of you, for any professional who has to diagnose it, decide and bring others along. Frameworks arranged by the seven stages a problem moves through.



Sanjay Chandra

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SEVEN STAGES
39 FRAMEWORKS

FRONT MATTER

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Seven stages, each a step up. Every line links to its page. THE BOOK ON ONE PAGE

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FRONT MATTER

What are you facing?

Find your situation, then open the card. START HERE

IF YOU ARE FACING THIS	OPEN THIS CARD		PAGE
You cannot tell what kind of problem this is	1.01	**Cynefin Framework**	06
An outside shift may hit your plan	1.02	**PESTLE and Five Forces**	06
You need an honest read of where you stand	1.03	**SWOT Analysis**	07
Customers are not buying what you offer	1.04	**Jobs-to-be-Done**	07
People resist a change and the reason is not obvious	2.01	**SCARF Model**	09
Two people or teams are in open conflict	2.02	**Thomas-Kilmann Model**	09
A team is busy but not delivering	2.03	**GRPI and 7S**	10
The same problem keeps coming back	2.04	**Root Cause Analysis**	10
One person is struggling with a task	2.05	**Situational Leadership**	11
You need help from people you do not manage	2.06	**Power/Interest Grid**	11
Each fix makes something else worse	2.07	**Causal Loop Diagram**	12
A discussion keeps going round in circles	3.01	**Six Thinking Hats**	14
Every option on the table looks the same	3.03	**First Principles Thinking**	15
You are about to negotiate	3.07	**BATNA**	17
You have more requests than you can do	4.02	**RICE Scoring**	19
Urgent work crowds out important work	4.03	**Eisenhower Matrix**	20
A plan has more risks than you can fix	4.04	**Risk Assessment Matrix**	20
Scope, date and budget pull against each other	4.05	**Triple Constraint**	21
Chance decides the result	4.06	**Decision Tree and Expected Value**	21
You must choose between a few clear options	4.07	**Weighted Scoring**	22
Nobody is sure who owns what	5.02	**RACI Matrix**	24
You must lead a large change	5.04	**Kotter and ADKAR**	25
You have one chance to brief senior people	6.01	**Pyramid Principle**	27
You need to give hard feedback	6.02	**Radical Candor and SBI**	27
You are deciding what to hand to AI	6.03	**CO-STAR and Human-in-the-Loop**	28
You have been avoiding a conversation	6.04	**Difficult Conversations**	28
You are interviewing a candidate	7.04	**STAR Method**	31
A new way of working was agreed but not used	7.05	**COM-B**	32
The same lesson keeps coming back	7.06	**Double-Loop Learning**	32

Not listed? Find the stage question in the **Contents** that you cannot yet answer, and start there.

FRONT MATTER

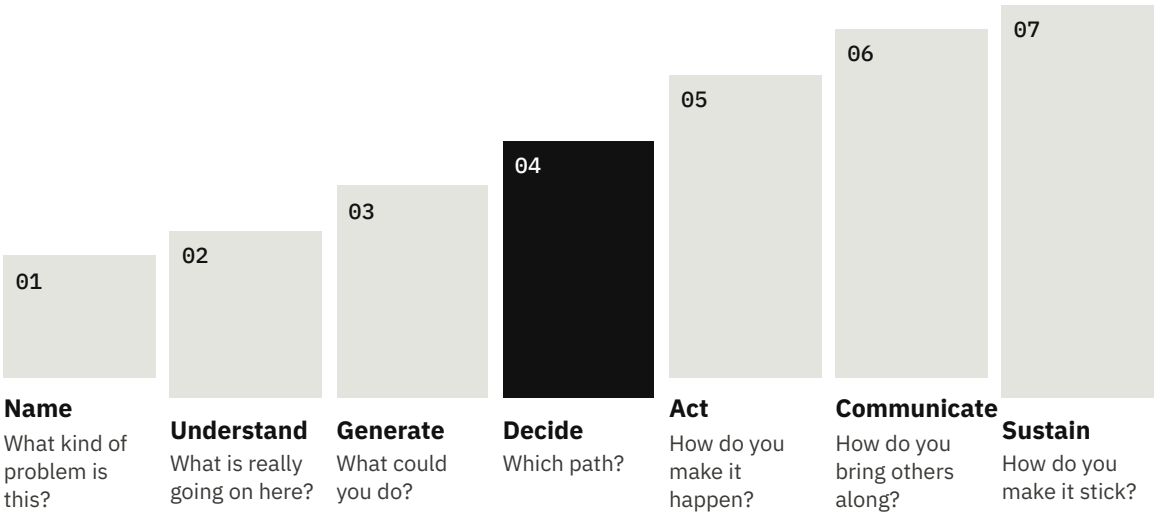
How to use this book

Seven stages, three rules, one card format.

READ FIRST

THE SEVEN STAGES

A problem moves through seven stages. Start at the first stage whose question you cannot yet answer.



Loop back as soon as a later stage shows that an earlier answer was wrong. Going back early is cheaper than going back late.

THREE RULES

01 **Write the problem in one sentence** before you pick any tool.

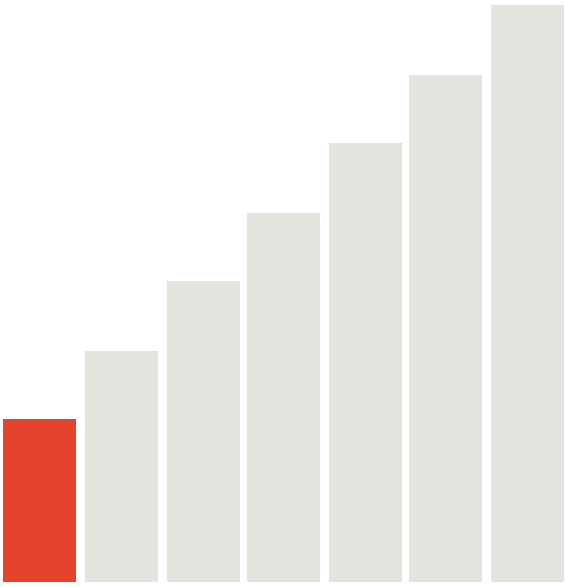
02 **Aim for a decision.** A filled-in framework is worth nothing on its own.

03 **Know who decides.** The framework sorts the facts. Often it is not you.

EACH CARD

One framework per card, two cards to a page, always in the same order:

LABEL AND SOURCE	USE IT WHEN	HOW IT WORKS	DIAGRAM	EXAMPLE	THE QUESTION IT ASKS



01 Name the Problem

"What kind of problem is this?"

Teams often work hard on the wrong problem. Check what it is before you spend the effort.

IN THIS STAGE		PAGE
1.01	Cynefin Framework	06
1.02	PESTLE and Five Forces	06
1.03	SWOT Analysis	07
1.04	Jobs-to-be-Done	07

Done when you can name the problem type, the key forces and the customer's job.

NEXT: STAGE 2, UNDERSTAND IT DEEPLY

1.01 CYNEFIN FRAMEWORK

David Snowden

Use it when: you are not sure whether to analyse, experiment or act at once.

HOW IT WORKS

Cynefin sorts situations by how clearly cause leads to effect. Clear and Complicated problems reward analysis and good practice. Complex problems need small, safe tests. Chaotic ones need fast action first. In Disorder, split the situation up and place each part.

UNORDERED	ORDERED
COMPLEX **Probe, sense, respond** cause seen only looking back emergent practice	COMPLICATED **Sense, analyse, respond** cause found by expert analysis good practice
CHAOTIC **Act, sense, respond** no cause and effect to see novel practice	CLEAR **Sense, categorise, respond** cause and effect obvious best practice

DISORDER
which kind? split it up

EXAMPLE Payroll fails on payday: Chaotic, so the finance lead pays staff by manual transfer first and investigates later. A new staff benefit is Complex, so HR trials it with one team first.

The question it asks: what kind of situation is this, before I decide what to do?

1.02 PESTLE AND FIVE FORCES

Francis Aguilar and Michael E. Porter

Use it when: outside changes or market pressure could upset your plans.

HOW IT WORKS

Work from wide to narrow. PESTLE scans six outside forces that could affect you in the next one to three years. Keep the two or three that matter. Five Forces then shows where power sits in your market.

STEP 1 PESTLE the wider world

P	**Political**	policy, tax, trade
E	**Economic**	rates, growth, costs
S	**Social**	people, habits, values
T	**Technological**	new tools, automation
L	**Legal**	laws now and coming
E	**Environmental**	climate, waste rules

STEP 2 FIVE FORCES your market

NEW ENTRANTS
can others start up easily?

SUPPLIERS
can they raise costs?

RIVALRY
how hard rivals fight

BUYERS
can they cut prices?

SUBSTITUTES
another way to do the job?

EXAMPLE A facilities firm reviews its plan. PESTLE flags new energy rules. Five Forces shows buyer power is the issue: three clients bring 60% of revenue. It widens its client base before the next price talks.

The question it asks: which outside forces matter, and who holds the power in our market?

1.03 SWOT ANALYSIS

SRI (1960s) and Heinz Weihrich (TOWS)

Use it when: you have a list of facts and need options for a plan.

HOW IT WORKS

List strengths and weaknesses inside the team, and opportunities and threats outside it. Then read across. Each place where an inside factor meets an outside one suggests a move. Pick two or three moves and test them.

Match each inside factor with an outside one	**STRENGTHS** inside the team, helps	**WEAKNESSES** inside the team, holds back
OPPORTUNITIES outside, could help	SO MOVE **Use strengths** to seize the opportunity	WO MOVE **Fix weaknesses** to seize the opportunity
THREATS outside, could hurt	ST MOVE **Use strengths** to meet the threat	WT MOVE **Shrink weaknesses** to avoid the threat

EXAMPLE A regional accounts team knows its clients well. A rival is closing local branches. SO move: offer those clients a named local contact. WT move: speed up slow month end checks before fees come under pressure.

The question it asks: where does an inside strength or weakness meet an outside change?

1.04 JOBS-TO-BE-DONE

Clayton Christensen

Use it when: you need to know why people really choose a product or service.

HOW IT WORKS

People hire a product or service to make progress on a job. Every job has three layers: functional, emotional and social. New ideas come from where people struggle with what they use now. Most teams stop at the functional layer.

THREE LAYERS OF A JOB

SOCIAL how they want others to see them

EMOTIONAL how they want to feel

FUNCTIONAL
the practical task to get done

WHY A JOB GETS HIRED

STRUGGLE what they use now falls short

↓

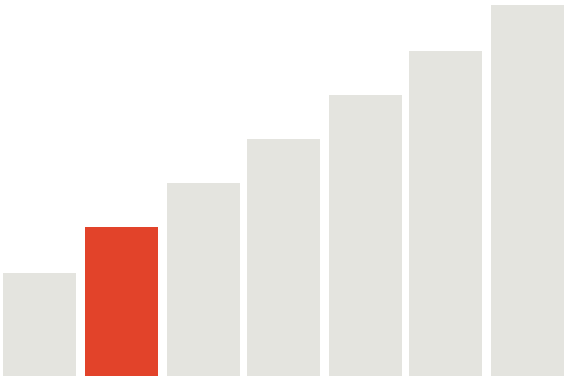
HIRE they bring in a product or service for the job

↓

PROGRESS the job gets done, life moves forward

EXAMPLE Staff avoid the new room booking tool. The jobs: book a room (functional), avoid being caught out (emotional) and look organised to visitors (social). Clear confirmations bring some back. The rest return once bookings by email stop.

The question it asks: what progress is this person trying to make, and what gets in the way?



02 Understand It Deeply

"What is really going on here?"

A wrong diagnosis costs more than a slow one.

IN THIS STAGE PAGE

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2.02	Thomas-Kilmann Model	09
2.03	GRPI and 7S	10
2.04	Root Cause Analysis	10
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2.06	Power/Interest Grid	11
2.07	Causal Loop Diagram	12

Done when you can name what is broken in one clear sentence.

NEXT: STAGE 3, GENERATE OPTIONS

2.01 SCARF MODEL

David Rock, 2008

Use it when: people resist a change and you cannot see why.

HOW IT WORKS

The brain treats a social threat much like a physical one, and stops cooperating. SCARF names five areas where that threat appears. Find the area under threat for each person. Then offer a reward in the same area, ideally before the meeting.

FEELS LIKE A THREAT	DOMAIN		FEELS LIKE A REWARD
public criticism	**S Status**	rank among others	recognition, being asked
vague plans, surprises	**C Certainty**	able to predict	clear plans and dates
micromanagement	**A Autonomy**	control over work	choice in how
being left out	**R Relatedness**	safe with others	being included
broken promises	**F Fairness**	a fair exchange	open, equal rules

EXAMPLE A manager plans to move her team to new desks. Certainty and Autonomy are at risk, so she shares the date early and lets each person choose their spot. The move goes ahead with far less grumbling.

The question it asks: which of the five areas feels threatened for this person?

2.02 THOMAS-KILMANN MODEL

Kenneth Thomas and Ralph Kilmann

Use it when: a disagreement keeps going the same way.

HOW IT WORKS

The model maps five conflict styles on two scales: how hard you push for your own needs, and how far you go along with others. Each style suits some situations. Know your habit, then choose the style that fits this one.



EXAMPLE Sales wants faster discounts and finance wants tighter control. The sales manager usually gives way. This time she chooses Collaborating, because both needs are fair. Finance agrees a quick sign off for small discounts only. The sales director's backing helped.

The question it asks: how hard do I push, how far do I go along, and does that fit?

2.03 GRPI AND 7S

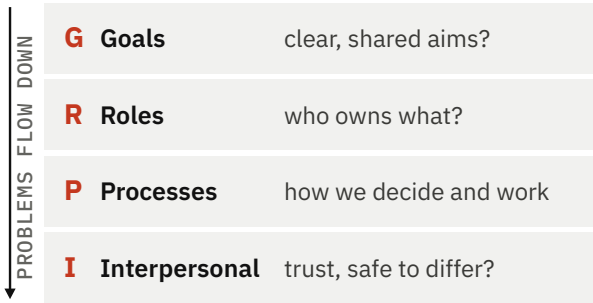
Richard Beckhard, and Peters and Waterman

Use it when: a team or organisation is struggling and you cannot see where.

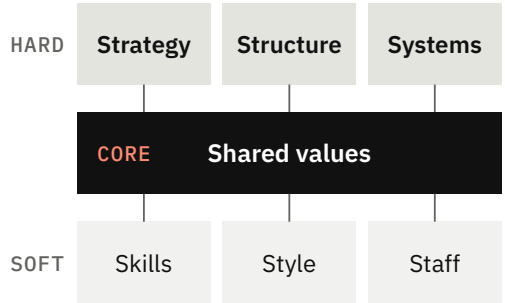
HOW IT WORKS

GRPI checks a team in four layers: goals, roles, processes, then relationships. Check from the top down and fix the highest broken layer first. Trouble lower down is often a symptom. For a whole organisation, McKinsey 7S finds the element out of line.

GRPI a team, checked top down



McKINSEY 7S the organisation



EXAMPLE A project team argues often. The lead checks goals first: they are clear. Roles are not, because two people think they own the budget. She gets the sponsor to say who owns it. Then most of the arguments stop.

The question it asks: which is the highest layer that is broken?

2.04 ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

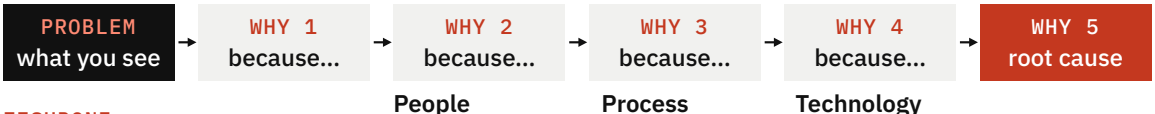
Sakichi Toyoda (5 Whys) and Kaoru Ishikawa (Fishbone)

Use it when: the same problem keeps coming back after each fix.

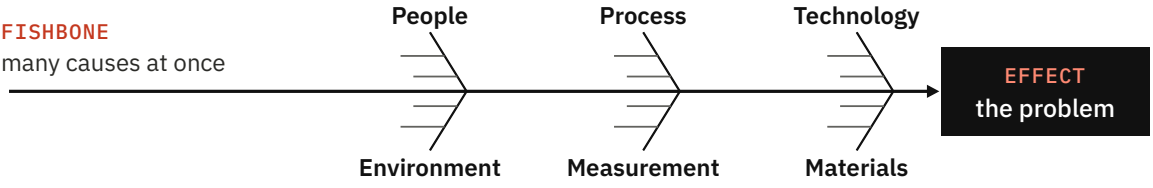
HOW IT WORKS

Fixing a symptom buys time. Fixing the root cause ends the problem. With one clear chain, ask why until you reach a process you can change. With many factors, draw a fishbone: one branch for each kind of cause, specific causes under each.

5 WHYS one chain of causes



FISHBONE
many causes at once



EXAMPLE A customer refund was missed. Why? Nobody saw the request. Why? An inbox rule stopped. Why? It ran under a leaver's access. Root cause: the leaver checklist skips inbox rules, so the team adds them.

The question it asks: why, and why again, until we reach something we can fix?

IN THE SERIES KP 5.02, 8.08

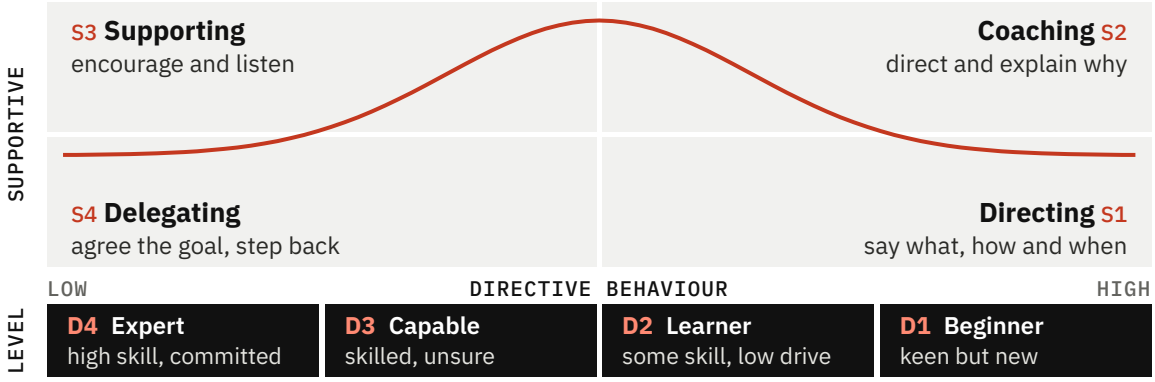
2.05 SITUATIONAL LEADERSHIP

Hersey and Blanchard, and Ken Blanchard (SLII)

Use it when: one way of leading works for some people but not others.

HOW IT WORKS

Read the person's skill and commitment for this one task. That gives a development level, D1 to D4. Match it with the style above it: Directing, Coaching, Supporting or Delegating. As they grow, step back.



EXAMPLE An analyst is expert on the monthly figures but new to client presentations. Her manager delegates the figures. For her first presentation he directs: what to cover, how long, and a rehearsal the day before.

The question it asks: how skilled and how committed is this person on this task?

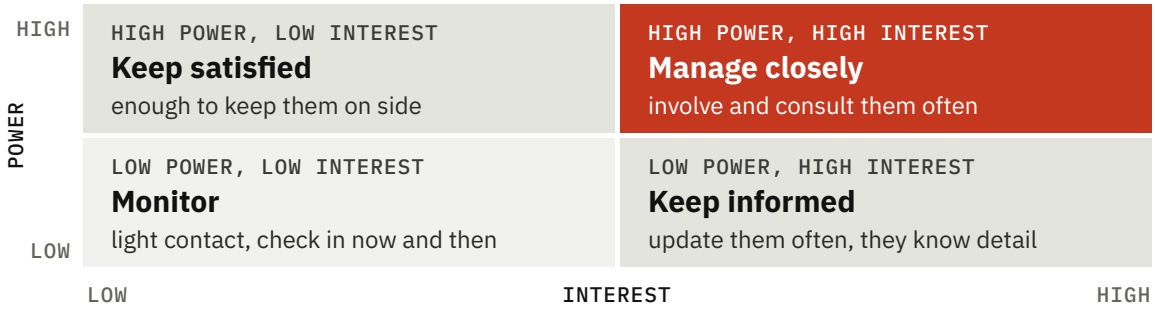
2.06 POWER/INTEREST GRID

Aubrey Mendelow, 1991

Use it when: many people care about a project and your time is limited.

HOW IT WORKS

Place each stakeholder by their power over the outcome and their interest in it. Each box needs a different level of contact. Spend most effort on high power, high interest. Redraw the map after each milestone, because interest changes.



EXAMPLE An HR lead is changing the leave policy. The finance director has power but little interest: a monthly note. Line managers cannot block it, but they can ignore it: regular updates and a say in rollout. The sponsor gets a weekly call.

The question it asks: who can affect this, and who cares about it?

IN THE SERIES KP 3.05 · HL 1.01, 1.07, 2.03, 6.07, 7.05

2.07 CAUSAL LOOP DIAGRAM

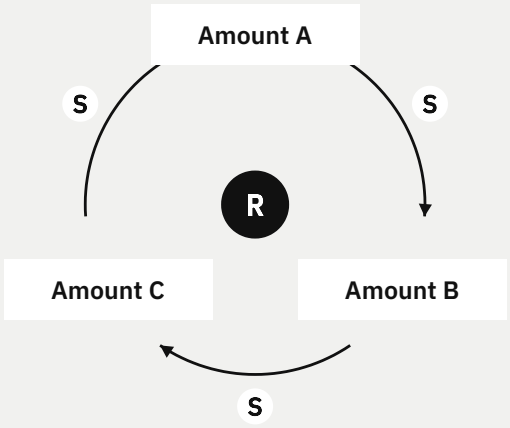
Jay Forrester and Peter Senge

Use it when: a problem comes back however often you fix it.

HOW IT WORKS

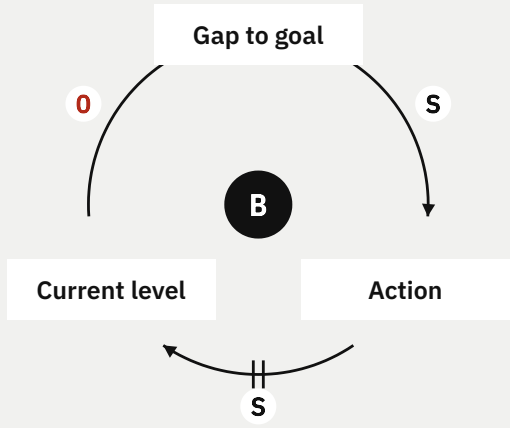
Some causes feed each other in a loop. Draw the amounts that rise or fall, with arrows between them. Mark each arrow S for same direction or O for opposite. An even number of O marks, or none, makes a reinforcing loop. An odd number makes a balancing loop. Act on a link.

REINFORCING LOOP runs further the same way



Each rise feeds the next rise, so growth or decline speeds up.

BALANCING LOOP pulls back to a goal



The gap drives action until the level reaches the goal, then it settles.

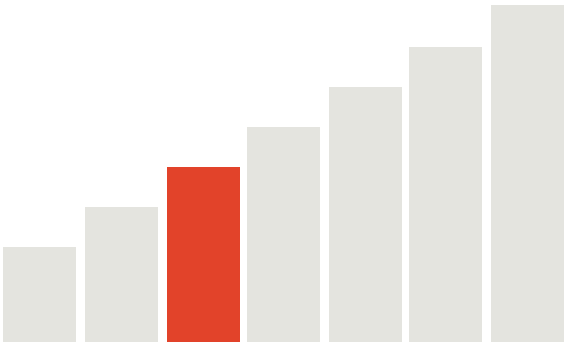
S same direction: up leads to up **O** opposite: up leads to down || a delay

1	**Name the pattern**	not one event: what keeps rising or falling?
2	**List the amounts**	things that can go up or down
3	**Draw and mark arrows**	S if both move the same way, O if opposite
4	**Count the O marks**	none or even: reinforcing, odd: balancing
5	**Act on a link**	weaken a reinforcing link, or strengthen a balance

EXAMPLE Month end errors rise each quarter. Workload drives overtime, overtime drives tiredness, tiredness drives errors and rework. The finance lead moves a third of reconciliations to mid month. Overtime falls, and errors with it.

The question it asks: what loop keeps this problem coming back?

IN THE SERIES KP 5.02



03 Generate Options

"What could you do?"

Most professionals generate two options and call it a choice.

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3.01	Six Thinking Hats	14
3.02	Blue Ocean Strategy	14
3.03	First Principles Thinking	15
3.04	Design Thinking	15
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3.06	Business Model Canvas	16
3.07	BATNA	17

Done when you hold two or three options with clearly different risks and rewards.

NEXT: STAGE 4, DECIDE

3.01 SIX THINKING HATS

Edward de Bono

Use it when: a group discussion keeps going round in circles.

HOW IT WORKS

Each hat is one way of thinking. Everyone wears the same hat at the same time, then the group moves on together. The blue hat runs the session and picks the order. Put facts and benefits before risks, so good ideas get a fair hearing.

ONE COMMON ORDER: EVERYONE WEARS THE SAME HAT AT ONCE

Blue opens → White → Yellow → **Black** → Green → Red → Blue closes

WHITE HAT **Facts** known facts and known gaps	YELLOW HAT **Benefits** why could this work?	BLACK HAT **Caution** what could go wrong?
GREEN HAT **New ideas** what else could we try?	RED HAT **Feelings** gut reaction, no reasons needed	BLUE HAT **Process** the chair: sets the order, sums up

EXAMPLE A team reviews a new office layout. Ten minutes on White, then Yellow, then Black. The director keeps to the order too, so juniors raise risks openly. Without that, the room follows her.

The question it asks: which kind of thinking are we all doing right now?

3.02 BLUE OCEAN STRATEGY

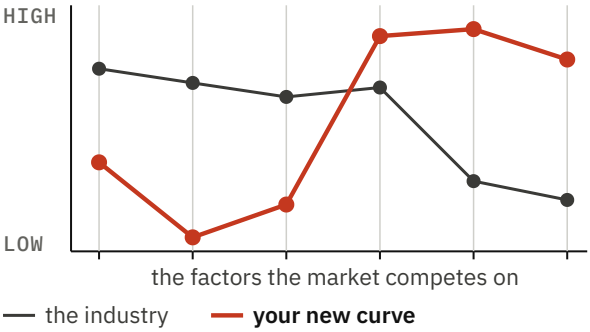
W. Chan Kim and Renée Mauborgne

Use it when: every rival competes on the same things and margins keep shrinking.

HOW IT WORKS

Draw the strategy canvas: the factors your market competes on, and how much each rival offers. Then take the four actions. Eliminate and reduce what buyers do not value. Raise and create what they do. Your new curve should look different from the rest.

STRATEGY CANVAS



FOUR ACTIONS, THE ERRC GRID

ELIMINATE drop what the industry assumes	RAISE lift well above the industry norm
REDUCE cut well below the industry norm	CREATE offer what no one has offered yet

lowers your cost | lifts buyer value

EXAMPLE An office cleaning firm drops the long contracts every rival insists on and cuts the glossy reports. It lets clients book and change visits online. Its prices fall, and fewer clients leave.

The question it asks: what could we stop doing, and what could we offer that nobody does?

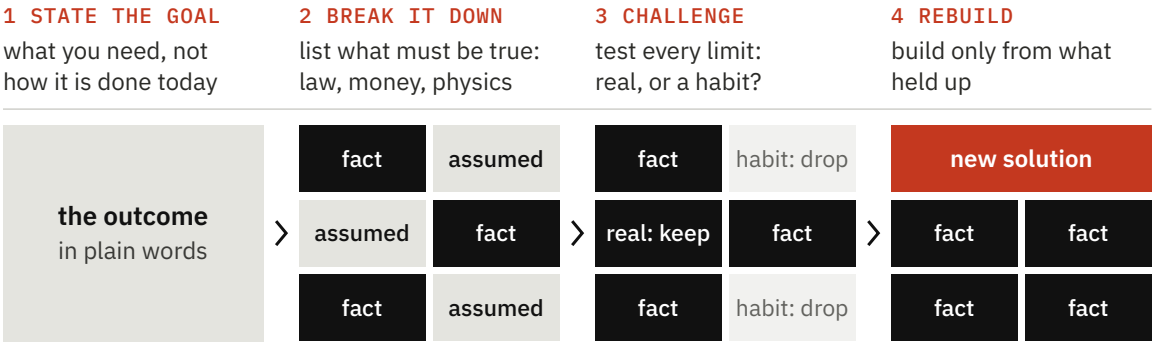
3.03 FIRST PRINCIPLES THINKING

Aristotle, popularised by Elon Musk

Use it when: copying how others do it has stopped working.

HOW IT WORKS

Most reasoning is by comparison: we do it this way because others do. First principles breaks a problem down to the facts that must be true. Test every limit against those facts: is it real, or a habit? Then rebuild using only what held up.



EXAMPLE An operations manager hears that every firm their size uses an outside warehouse. The real job is getting goods from supplier to customer. Two suppliers can ship direct, so the space needed halves.

The question it asks: what must be true here, and what is only habit?

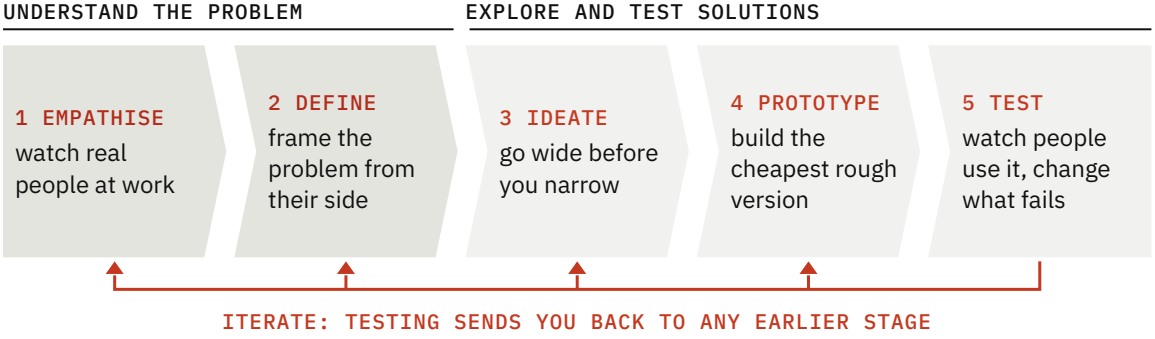
3.04 DESIGN THINKING

IDEO and Stanford d.school

Use it when: you are about to build a fix for people you have not watched.

HOW IT WORKS

Start with the people. Watch them work, then frame the problem from their side. Go wide on ideas, build the cheapest rough version and test it with real people. Testing sends you back to earlier stages, and that loop is the point.



EXAMPLE An HR team plans a faster expenses form. First they watch ten staff claim. Every one gives up at the receipt step. A paper mock-up with a photo option tests the fix in a day.

The question it asks: what do people actually do?

IN THE SERIES HL 3.05

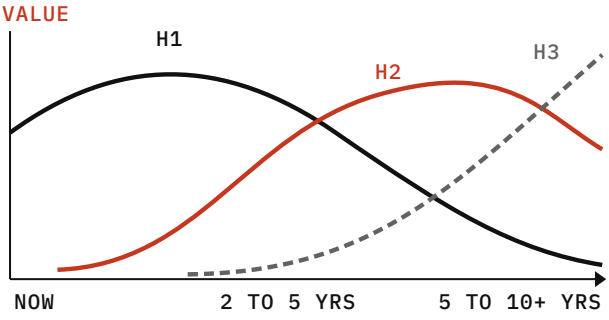
3.05 THREE HORIZONS FRAMEWORK

McKinsey and Company

Use it when: today's business takes all the money and attention.

HOW IT WORKS

Horizon 1 is the core business that pays the bills today. Horizon 2 is new ventures that should earn in two to five years. Horizon 3 is small bets that may matter in ten. Fund and lead all three at the same time.



ALL THREE AT ONCE

H1 CORE
defend and extend what earns today, 0 to 3 years

H2 EMERGING
new ventures near the core, real revenue in 2 to 5 years

H3 FUTURE
small bets and trials that may matter in 5 to 10 years

EXAMPLE A training firm runs its classroom courses as H1, an online course for client teams as H2, and two small trials with schools as H3. Each has a named lead and budget. In a bad quarter, H3 is cut first.

The question it asks: what are we doing today for the business we need in five years?

3.06 BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS

Alexander Osterwalder

Use it when: you need to see how a whole business makes its money.

HOW IT WORKS

The canvas puts a business on one page in nine blocks. The right side is who you serve, the left is how you deliver, the bottom is the money. Every block is a guess. Change one, see what else must change, and test the weakest guesses first.

HOW YOU DELIVER		WHAT YOU OFFER		WHO YOU SERVE
KEY PARTNERS who helps us, and with what?	KEY ACTIVITIES the main work KEY RESOURCES assets we need	VALUE PROPOSITIONS what value do we deliver, and for which need?	CUSTOMER RELATIONSHIPS the bond expected CHANNELS how we reach them	CUSTOMER SEGMENTS who are we creating value for?
COST STRUCTURE what costs most, and which activities drive it?			REVENUE STREAMS what will customers pay for, and how?	

EXAMPLE A facilities team wants to rent its meeting rooms to outside firms. The canvas shows the new customers need a booking channel and a cleaning partner, and the cleaning cost sets the price.

The question it asks: how does this business create, deliver and earn value?

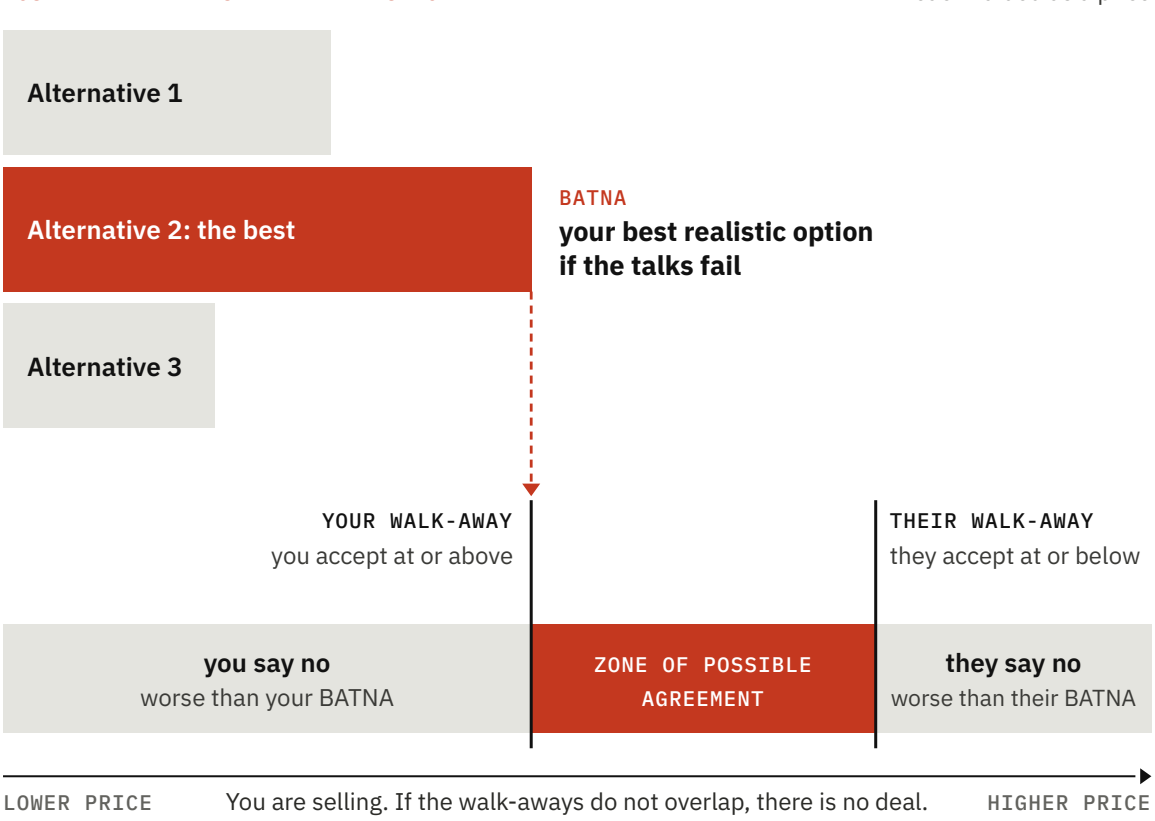
3.07 BATNA

Roger Fisher and William Ury

Use it when: you are about to negotiate and wonder how hard to push.

HOW IT WORKS

Your BATNA is your best alternative to a negotiated agreement: what you will do if this deal fails. It sets your walk-away point. Estimate the other side's too. A deal is only possible between the two. If your BATNA is weak, improve it before you talk.



1 LIST everything you could do if this deal fails

2 PICK the best realistic one: that is your BATNA

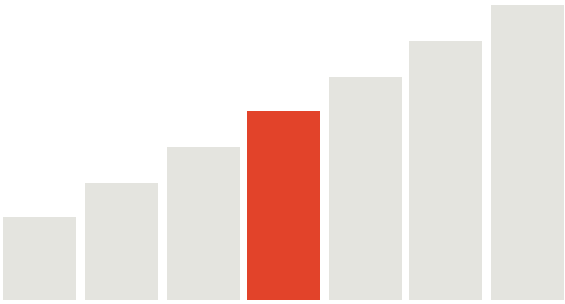
3 SET your walk-away: refuse any offer worse than it

4 ESTIMATE their BATNA, and so their walk-away

5 STRENGTHEN improve your BATNA before you talk

EXAMPLE A procurement lead renews the print contract. Supplier B would do the work for 15% more. Her director agrees she can switch. Any offer from Supplier A must beat B on total value, or she walks away.

The question it asks: what will we do if this deal falls through?



04 Decide

"Which path?"

A tool will not decide for you. Often someone senior has decided already. Find out first.

IN THIS STAGE		PAGE
4.01	MECE Framework	19
4.02	RICE Scoring	19
4.03	Eisenhower Matrix	20
4.04	Risk Assessment Matrix	20
4.05	Triple Constraint	21
4.06	Decision Tree and Expected Value	21
4.07	Weighted Scoring	22

Done when you can say the path, why it won, who owns it and who with budget backs it.

NEXT: STAGE 5, ACT

4.01 MECE FRAMEWORK

McKinsey and Company

Use it when: your list of causes or options feels messy or incomplete.

HOW IT WORKS

MECE means mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive. Split a problem into groups that do not overlap and leave nothing out. Use one rule for each split, then split each group again.

WHOLE	PARTS split by one rule	SUB PARTS split again by one rule	
The problem everything in scope	**Part A**	**A1**	**A2**
	Part B	**B1**	**B2**
	Part C	**C1**	**C2**

NO OVERLAP each item fits one box only

NO GAP the parts add up to the whole

EXAMPLE Sixty invoices were paid late last month. The finance lead splits them by stage: before approval, waiting for approval, after approval. Each invoice fits one stage, and the three add up to sixty. Waiting for approval is the biggest group.

The question it asks: does every item sit in one box, and only one?

4.02 RICE SCORING

Intercom

Use it when: the request list is long and everyone says theirs comes first.

HOW IT WORKS

RICE scores each item on four factors. Reach is how many people it affects. Impact is how much it helps each one. Confidence is how sure you are. Divide by effort, then work down the list from the top.

REACH		IMPACT		CONFIDENCE		EFFORT		SCORE
people it affects	×	**help to each**	×	**how sure you are**	÷	**work it takes**	=	**rank by it**
count per quarter		3 massive to 0.25 tiny		100% proof, 50% a guess		person weeks		highest goes first

RANKED LIST 1 2 3 4 work down from the top

EXAMPLE An HR team has four requests. Fixing the expense form reaches 300 staff, impact 1, confidence 80%, two weeks of effort: 300 × 1 × 0.8 ÷ 2 = 120. The highest score goes first, unless a director's request jumps the queue. The scores show what that costs.

The question it asks: how many people, how much good, how sure, for what effort?

IN THE SERIES KP 8.03

4.03 EISENHOWER MATRIX

Dwight D. Eisenhower

Use it when: your day is full and the important work never happens.

HOW IT WORKS

Urgent means it needs attention now. Important means it moves your goals. Most days are spent on urgent work, important or not. Sort every task on both questions, then act on each box differently.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	DO NOW crises, deadlines	SCHEDULE planning, growth
NOT IMPORTANT	DELEGATE interruptions	DROP busywork

EXAMPLE An office manager's Monday: the supplier cancellation goes in Do now, next quarter's plan in Schedule, room bookings in Delegate. Her director's request is Do now, whatever it is.

The question it asks: is this urgent, is it important, or both?

4.04 RISK ASSESSMENT MATRIX

ISO 31000 risk practice

Use it when: a plan has many risks and you cannot fix them all.

HOW IT WORKS

Rate each risk on two questions: how likely is it, and how bad would it be? Place it on the grid. High on both means act now. Low on both means watch it. Everything in between needs a named owner.

LIKELIHOOD \ IMPACT	LOW	MEDIUM	HIGH
HIGH	Owner	Owner	Act now
MEDIUM	Watch	Owner	Owner
LOW	Watch	Watch	Owner

ACT NOW
likely and serious. A senior person leads.

NAME AN OWNER
reduce it, or pass it on by contract or insurance.

WATCH
accept it and review it each month.

EXAMPLE A team moves office in March. No internet on day one is likely and serious, so the IT lead orders the line early. A spare van covers late movers. Lost boxes are only watched.

The question it asks: how likely is it, and how bad if it happens?

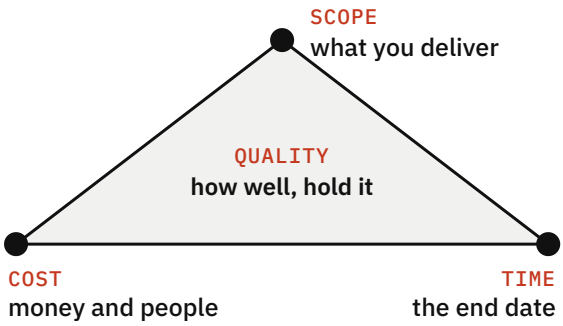
4.05 TRIPLE CONSTRAINT

Martin Barnes, 1969, the iron triangle

Use it when: someone wants more, but the date and budget stay the same.

HOW IT WORKS

Scope, time and cost are tied together. Change one and at least one other must move. Quality sits in the middle and should not be what quietly gives. Name the corner that moves and agree it openly.



ONE CORNER MOVES, ONE MUST GIVE

GIVE ON TIME
move the date

GIVE ON COST
add money or people

GIVE ON SCOPE
cut or defer some work

EXAMPLE An office refit has £80k and a 1 May deadline. The director adds a second floor and wants the date kept. The lead sends three choices by email: June, £45k more, or floor two next year. They move the date.

The question it asks: if one limit moves, which other one gives?

IN THE SERIES HL 5.08, 8.04

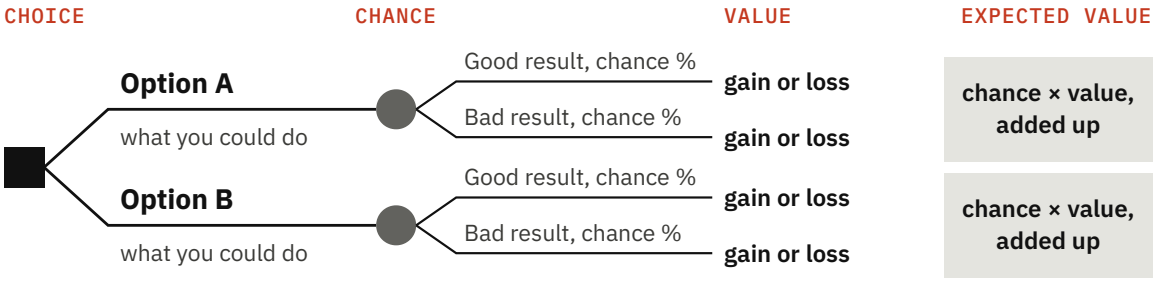
4.06 DECISION TREE AND EXPECTED VALUE

Howard Raiffa

Use it when: chance decides the result, and you could test first.

HOW IT WORKS

Draw each choice as a square and each chance as a circle. Put a rough chance and a value on every branch. Multiply each value by its chance and add them up: that is the expected value. Then check the worst case.



EXAMPLE A finance lead can launch a new expense process in all six teams, or trial it in one. Launching everywhere averages a £15k gain but could lose £30k. The trial averages £25k, and its worst loss is £5k.

The question it asks: what is each choice worth on average, and what is the worst case?

4.07 WEIGHTED SCORING

Stuart Pugh, the Pugh matrix, 1981

Use it when: a few options differ on several things that matter.

HOW IT WORKS

Give each criterion that matters a weight. The weights add up to 100%. Score every option on every criterion from 1 to 5. Multiply each score by its weight and add them up. Agree the weights first and keep that version. People will still try to bend them toward a favourite.

CRITERIA
what matters, 3 to 6 of them

WEIGHTS
how much each counts, adding up to 100%

SCORES
each option on each criterion, 1 poor to 5 strong

CRITERION	WEIGHT	OPTION A	OPTION B	OPTION C
Criterion 1	40%	1 to 5	1 to 5	1 to 5
Criterion 2	30%	1 to 5	1 to 5	1 to 5
Criterion 3	20%	1 to 5	1 to 5	1 to 5
Criterion 4	10%	1 to 5	1 to 5	1 to 5
WEIGHTED TOTAL weight × score, added		total	total	total

1 **Agree** criteria and weights before anyone scores

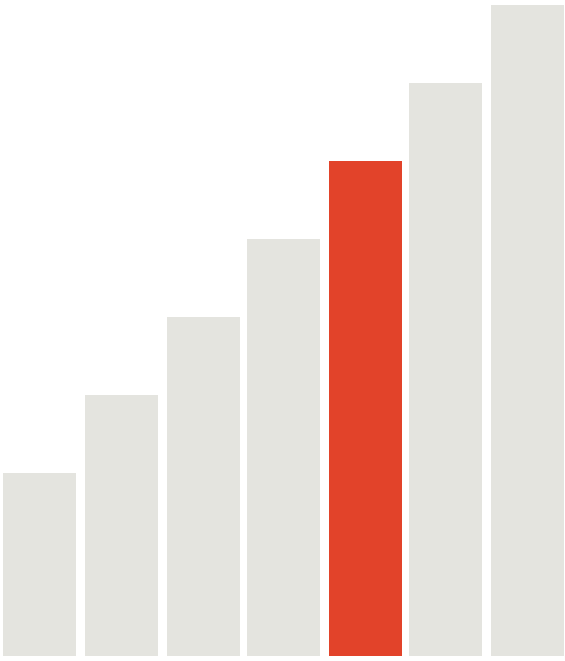
2 **Score** every option, with a line of evidence

3 **Multiply** each score by its weight, then add

4 **Test** move the biggest weight 10 points. Does the winner change?

EXAMPLE An office manager compares three cleaning firms on reliability 40%, cost 30%, references 20% and start date 10%. Firm C totals 3.6. A and B total 3.1 each. With cost at 20% and reliability at 50%, C still wins.

The question it asks: which option wins on what matters most, even if the weights move?



05 Act

"How do you make it happen?"

A decision nobody acts on is only an opinion.

IN THIS STAGE		PAGE
5.01	OKRs	24
5.02	RACI Matrix	24
5.03	Agile: Scrum and Kanban	25
5.04	Kotter and ADKAR	25

Done when the new way runs without you pushing it each week.

NEXT: STAGE 6, COMMUNICATE

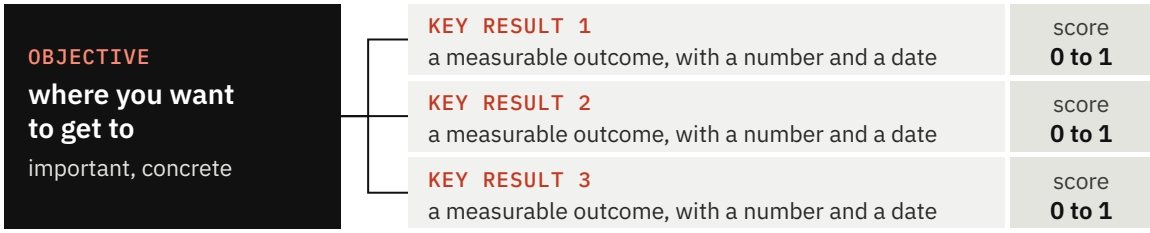
5.01 OKRS

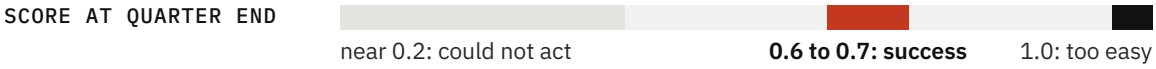
Andy Grove, made popular by Google

Use it when: teams pull different ways and a senior person will review the scores.

HOW IT WORKS

The objective is where you want to get to. Three to five key results prove you got there, each with a number and a date. Without a number it is a task. Score each from 0 to 1 at quarter end. On a stretch goal, 0.6 to 0.7 is success.





EXAMPLE A service head sets the objective: members love the new loyalty scheme. One key result: satisfaction of 45 or more by the end of Q3, up from 31.

The question it asks: where do we want to get to, and how will we know we got there?

IN THE SERIES KP 7.04

5.02 RACI MATRIX

A project management basic

Use it when: two people each think the other owns a task, or nobody does.

HOW IT WORKS

List the tasks down the side and the people across the top. Give each person one of four roles on each task. Many people can be Responsible, but only one is Accountable. If a task seems to need two, split it.

	PERSON 1	PERSON 2	PERSON 3	PERSON 4
Task 1	A	R	C	I
Task 2	C	A	R	I
Task 3	I	R	A	C
Task 4	A	C	R	I

Check each row: exactly one A, at least one R.

FOUR ROLES

- **A** ACCOUNTABLE — answers for the result, one only
- **R** RESPONSIBLE — does the work, can be several
- **C** CONSULTED — asked before, two-way
- **I** INFORMED — told after, one-way

EXAMPLE A product launch has four tasks. The project manager is A on the launch plan. The analyst is R on the costs. Legal is C on the terms. The directors are I on every row, but can overrule any of it.

The question it asks: who answers for this, and who does the work?

IN THE SERIES KP 2.01, T.01 · HL 7.08

5.03 AGILE: SCRUM AND KANBAN

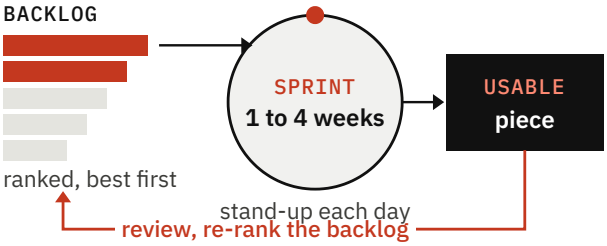
Agile Manifesto, 2001

Use it when: the plan keeps changing and you need to deliver in pieces.

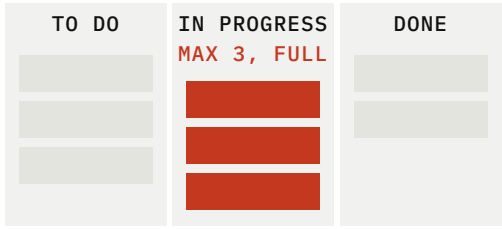
HOW IT WORKS

Agile delivers in small pieces, gets feedback and adjusts. In Scrum, the team takes the top of the backlog, a ranked list of work, into a sprint, a fixed cycle of one to four weeks. Kanban suits work that arrives all the time, and caps the work in progress.

SCRUM: FIXED CYCLES



KANBAN: STEADY FLOW



Full? Finish one before you start another.

EXAMPLE A marketing team runs its spring campaign in two week sprints, showing a draft each fortnight. Customer requests go on a Kanban board, three in progress at most. When a director adds a fourth, the team asks which one waits.

The question it asks: what can we finish and show next, and what is stuck?

IN THE SERIES KP 4.02

5.04 KOTTER AND ADKAR

John P. Kotter and Prosci (ADKAR)

Use it when: a big change means many people must work differently.

HOW IT WORKS

Kotter's eight steps lead the change for the whole organisation, in three phases. ADKAR checks each person against five milestones, in order. Find the first one a person has not cleared and work on that. Training will not help someone stuck at desire.

CREATE A CLIMATE			ENGAGE AND ENABLE			IMPLEMENT, SUSTAIN	
1 Sense of urgency	2 Guiding coalition	3 Strategic vision	4 Volunteer army	5 Remove barriers	6 Short-term wins	7 Sustain the pace	8 Institute change

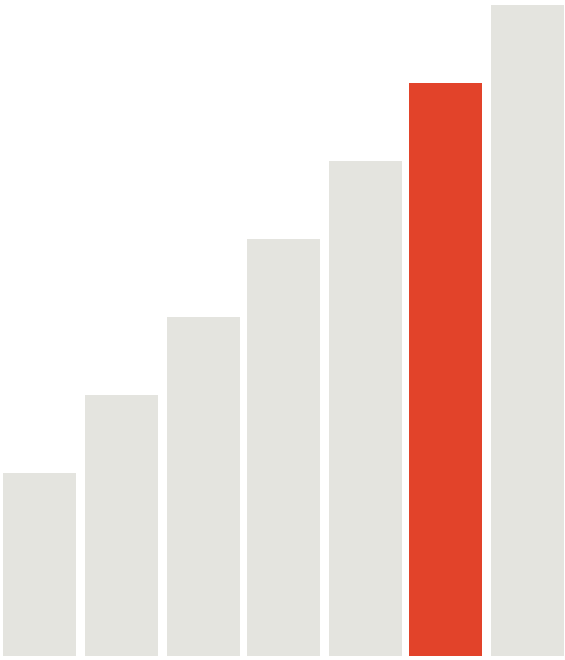
ADKAR: EACH PERSON CLEARS FIVE MILESTONES, IN ORDER

A AWARENESS why change?	D DESIRE do I want to?	K KNOWLEDGE do I know how?	A ABILITY can I do it?	R REINFORCEMENT will it stick?

EXAMPLE A firm moves six offices to a new sales system. The director shows the lost sales, wins over twelve respected managers and starts with one office. Two offices stall at desire until the old system is switched off.

The question it asks: where is the organisation on the route, and where is each person stuck?

IN THE SERIES KP 8.02, 8.04



06 Communicate

"How do you bring others along?"

Give them the answer in the first sentence.

IN THIS STAGE		PAGE
6.01	**Pyramid Principle**	27
6.02	**Radical Candor and SBI**	27
6.03	**CO-STAR and Human-in-the-Loop**	28
6.04	**Difficult Conversations**	28

Done when the people who decide act on it, or you know why they will not.

NEXT: STAGE 7, SUSTAIN

6.01 PYRAMID PRINCIPLE

Barbara Minto, McKinsey

Use it when: you must brief a busy person who may stop listening early.

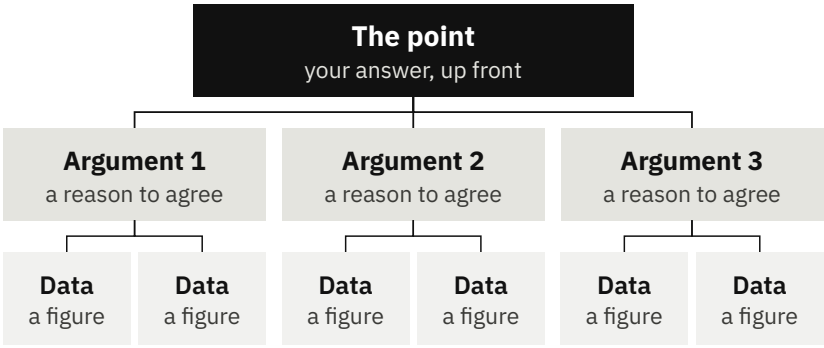
HOW IT WORKS

Start with your answer in one sentence. Below it, give three to five reasons that do not overlap. Below each reason, give the data that proves it. For each figure, say what it means and what to do.

1 THE POINT
one sentence, said first

2 ARGUMENTS
3 to 5 reasons, no overlap

3 DATA
proof for each reason



EXAMPLE A finance manager briefs the director on travel costs. She opens: “Move to one travel agency. It saves £40k a year.” Then three reasons, lower fares, one invoice and duty of care, each with a figure.

The question it asks: what is my answer, and what proves it?

IN THE SERIES KP 3.01, 3.02, 5.03

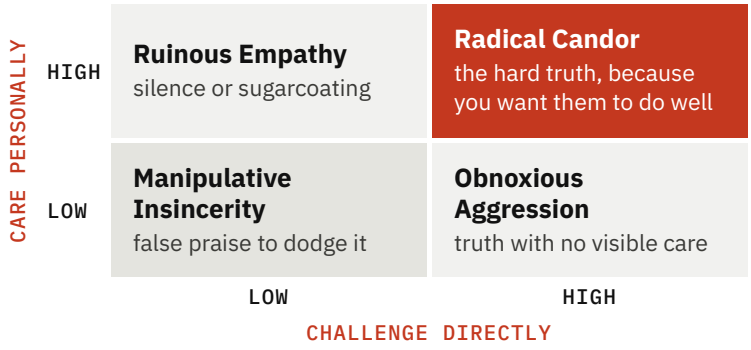
6.02 RADICAL CANDOR AND SBI

Kim Scott and the Center for Creative Leadership (SBI)

Use it when: you owe someone feedback and keep putting it off. Upward, weigh the cost first.

HOW IT WORKS

Radical Candor means caring about the person and challenging them directly, both at once. Care without challenge is Ruinous Empathy. Challenge without care is Obnoxious Aggression. SBI is how to say it: the Situation, the Behaviour you saw and its Impact. Then agree the next step.



SAY IT WITH SBI

- **S** Situation — when and where
- **B** Behaviour — the actions you saw
- **I** Impact — what it caused, for whom
- **+** Next step — agree what changes

EXAMPLE A team lead says: “In Tuesday’s client call, you answered before the client finished. They went quiet and never raised their concern. Could you pause next time?”

The question it asks: do I care enough to say it, and plainly enough to help?

IN THE SERIES HL 3.01

6.03 CO-STAR AND HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP

CO-STAR, GovTech Singapore

Use it when: AI drafts some of your work and the output is generic.

HOW IT WORKS

CO-STAR is a six-part brief for the AI: Context, Objective, Style, Tone, Audience and Response format. Human-in-the-Loop is the loop around it: you direct, the AI generates, you audit and refine. The audit is the step people skip.

STEP 1, DIRECT: BRIEF THE AI WITH CO-STAR

C	O	S	T	A	R
Context the background	**Objective** the task	**Style** whose voice	**Tone** the attitude	**Audience** who reads it	**Response** the format

THE LOOP: WHO DOES EACH STEP



EXAMPLE An orders manager briefs the AI on a two-week delay for a customer's finance director. The draft takes three minutes. She spends fifteen checking the facts and rewriting the close in her own voice.

The question it asks: did I brief it fully, and did I check every fact?

6.04 DIFFICULT CONVERSATIONS

Stone, Patton and Heen, Harvard Negotiation Project

Use it when: a talk you would rather avoid can no longer wait.

HOW IT WORKS

Each difficult conversation is really three: what happened, the feelings, and what it says about each person. Prepare all three. Then hold a learning conversation: a neutral third story, their story, your story as your view, then solve it together.

PREPARE: THREE CONVERSATIONS

- **What happened?** intent and impact, each side's contribution
- **Feelings** yours and theirs, named
- **Identity** what it says about each of you

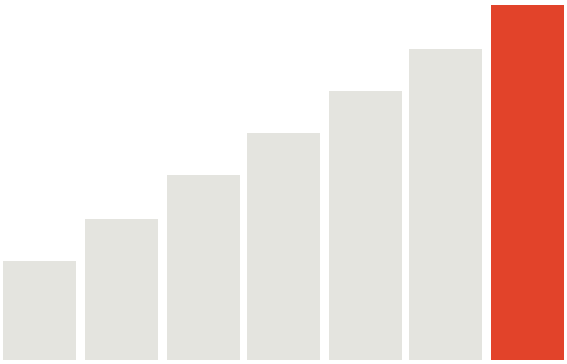
HOLD: A LEARNING CONVERSATION

1	**The third story**	a neutral account both would recognise
2	**Their story**	listen, ask, acknowledge
3	**Your story**	told as your view
4	**Solve together**	options that meet both sides' main concerns

EXAMPLE A manager must raise a missed supplier deadline. She opens: "I think we see last month differently. I want to hear your side and tell you mine. Then we agree, or I decide."

The question it asks: what is their story, and what is mine?

IN THE SERIES KP 7.07 · HL 2.02, 3.02



07 Sustain

"How do you make it stick?"

Willpower runs out. Routines fade too, unless someone checks them or they save work.

IN THIS STAGE		PAGE
7.01	Atomic Habits and WOOP	30
7.02	Getting Things Done	30
7.03	GROW Model	31
7.04	STAR Method	31
7.05	COM-B	32
7.06	Double-Loop Learning	32

Done when your own habits hold, and team routines still run when the boss asks about them.

NEXT: CASE A, ONE PROBLEM THROUGH ALL SEVEN STAGES

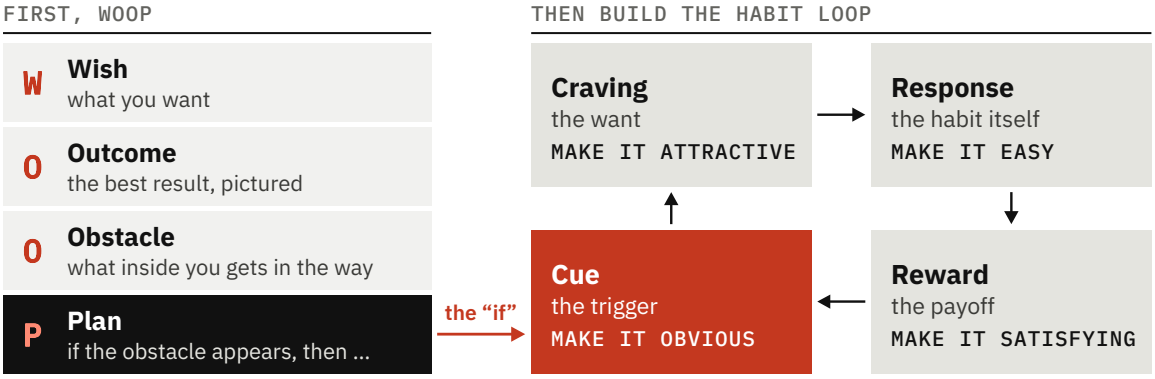
7.01 ATOMIC HABITS AND WOOP

James Clear and Gabriele Oettingen (WOOP)

Use it when: you keep meaning to start a habit and never do.

HOW IT WORKS

Every habit runs on a loop: cue, craving, response, reward. Make the cue obvious, the habit attractive, the start easy and the reward satisfying. Begin with WOOP: wish, outcome, the obstacle inside you, and an if-then plan. The "if" becomes your cue.



EXAMPLE An analyst wants to finish a finance course. Her obstacle: scrolling her phone after work. Her plan: if I reach for my phone at 7pm, I open the module for ten minutes.

The question it asks: what is my cue, and what inside me gets in the way?

7.02 GETTING THINGS DONE

David Allen

Use it when: you feel behind and keep forgetting what you promised.

HOW IT WORKS

Stop holding tasks in your head. Capture every task in one inbox. Clarify each item: what is the next action? Organise it onto the right list. Review every list weekly, then choose what to do now.



EXAMPLE A sales coordinator empties her email, notes and desk tray into one inbox. Each item becomes a next action, a delegated item, a file or the bin. Her Friday review takes 45 minutes.

The question it asks: what is the next action, and where does it live?

IN THE SERIES KP 1.02

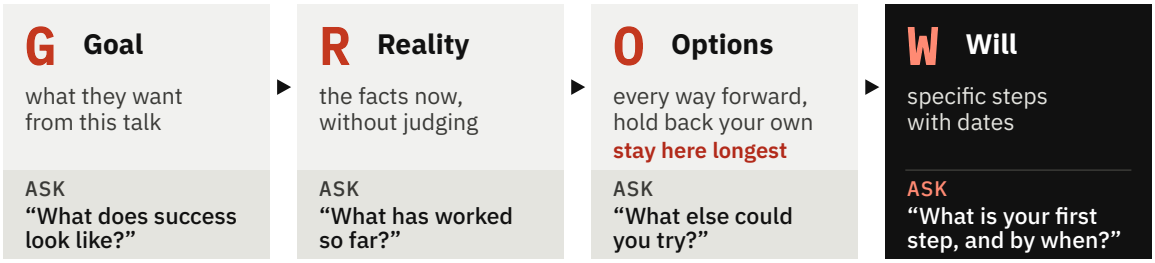
7.03 GROW MODEL

Sir John Whitmore

Use it when: someone brings you a problem they could solve themselves.

HOW IT WORKS

GROW is a coaching conversation in four stages of questions: Goal, Reality, Options, Will. The manager asks and the person finds the answer. People keep to their own answers better than to yours. Stay longest on Options, and end with a dated first step.



The manager asks. The person finds the answer and owns the first step.

EXAMPLE An office manager asks how to stop meeting room clashes. Her director asks: what would good look like? What happens now? What could you try? She picks a booking rule, starting Monday. He agrees to back it when people ignore it.

The question it asks: what do they want, and what will they do first?

IN THE SERIES KP 7.06

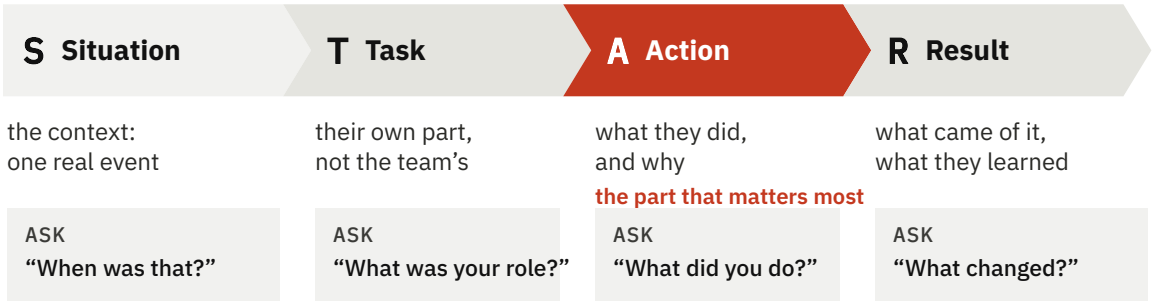
7.04 STAR METHOD

Behavioural interviewing practice

Use it when: you need evidence of what a candidate has actually done.

HOW IT WORKS

Past behaviour is the best guide to future behaviour. Ask for one real event, then draw out four parts: the Situation, their Task, the Action they took and the Result. Action matters most. When you hear “we”, ask “What did you do?”



One past event, told in order. Hear “we”? Ask what they did.

EXAMPLE An interviewer for a payroll role asks about a missed deadline. The candidate describes the month end, her part, her checklist and the result: no late payments in six months. Each interviewer scores it before the panel talks.

The question it asks: what did this person do, and what came of it?

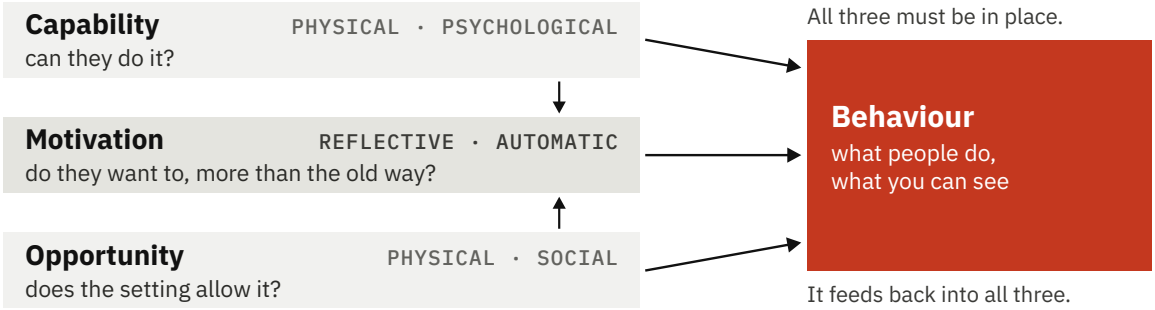
7.05 COM-B

Susan Michie, University College London

Use it when: people said yes to a change but still work the old way.

HOW IT WORKS

A behaviour happens only when three things are in place. Capability: can they do it? Opportunity: does the setting allow it? Motivation: do they want to, more than the old way? Name the behaviour exactly, find the missing piece and pick the fix that matches.



EXAMPLE Field sales staff file expenses late. The form fails on a phone, and managers never ask. Finance fixes the form. The sales director tells managers to ask. Late claims fall from 40 to 8 percent.

The question it asks: can they, does the setting let them, and do they want to?

IN THE SERIES KP 8.02

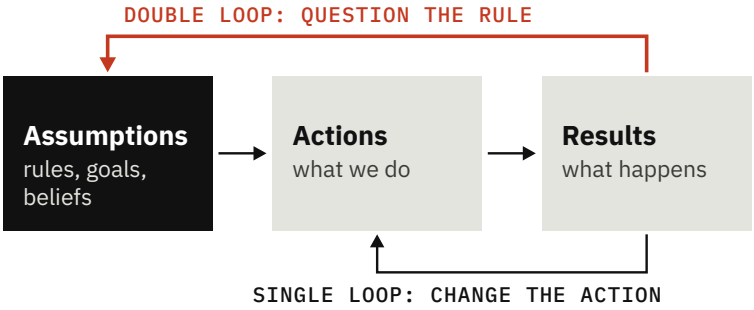
7.06 DOUBLE-LOOP LEARNING

Chris Argyris and Donald Schön

Use it when: the same problem keeps coming back after every fix.

HOW IT WORKS

Single-loop learning fixes the action and keeps the rule behind it. Double-loop learning asks whether the rule, goal or belief is the real problem. Ask what had to be true for the plan to work. Change the rule, then check the results.



TO FIND THE RULE, ASK

1. What had to be true for the plan to work?
2. Which rule were we protecting?
3. If that belief were wrong, what then?

EXAMPLE Complaint replies keep missing the 48-hour target, and reminders do not help. The rule was “every complaint gets a full letter”. Most need only a call. The head of service signs off a new rule. On-time replies rise from 70 to 95 percent.

The question it asks: is the action wrong, or the rule behind it?

IN THE SERIES KP 8.07

WORKED CASE

Case A: Where 200 reports go next

One problem through all seven stages, one card at each. The people and figures are invented.

ONE DECISION

THE PROBLEM

About 200 regular reports run on an old system. Support ends in March 2027, and renewal costs £540,000 for three years. The board pack needs the figures by 6 am each day. You must recommend what happens next by 30 October.

01 NAME	1.01 **Cynefin Framework**	Experts can weigh this, and others have made the move. Complicated: analyse, then act.
02 UNDERSTAND	2.06 **Power/Interest Grid**	The CFO has high power and high interest: manage closely. Sam built the old reports and could slow the move, so he leads the pilot.
03 GENERATE	3.03 **First Principles Thinking**	What must be true: figures by 6 am, a lower three-year cost, a system the team can run.
04 DECIDE	4.07 **Weighted Scoring**	Weights set with the CFO first, after asking what she leans towards. C scores 3.6, A and B 3.1. C still wins when cost drops.
05 ACT	5.02 **RACI Matrix**	Priya is accountable for the move. Sam and Lee do the work. The CFO is consulted before each switch.
06 COMMUNICATE	6.01 **Pyramid Principle**	One page to the CFO, answer first: rebuild in waves, a third cheaper, old system on to the end, so the 6 am pack is safe.
07 SUSTAIN	7.06 **Double-Loop Learning**	At the 1 December review, test the wave. Raise any doubt about the choice there, as it will not be reopened later. Waves run from KP S.03. Recount with KP 8.02.

A	B	C
Renew £540k over three years, no change	**Move as is** about £450k, fast, same weak spots	**Rebuild in waves** about £360k, slower start, fewer failures

DECISION

Option C: rebuild in waves on a system the IT head has agreed to run, checking each wave against the old one first.

OWNER AND REVIEW

Priya. Approved 30 October 2026. Review on 1 December 2026, after the pilot wave.

CONCLUSION

You now have 39 tools.

The hard part is using them.

FINAL WORD

39.

A framework helps you ask better questions before you act. Reaching for one is a sign of care. It shows you know where instinct runs out.

The value builds over time. The first time you use SCARF before a hard conversation, you will feel the difference. The first time Root Cause Analysis finds a fault in how the work is set up, where everyone had blamed one person, you will have a case to make for them.

Open this book at the stage where you are stuck. Start from the situation. The framework serves it.

A FINAL PRINCIPLE

Use the tools to see clearly. Then check who decides and what they already want.

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